THE VELVET ROPE QUIZ · YOUR WORKSHEET

Lift the Velvet Rope

A one-page worksheet for the few seconds that decide everything.

Use this right after something happens: a slow reply, a "boring" date, a first impression you've already made up your mind about. It takes two minutes. Simple, not easy, because the meaning always feels true while you're inside it.

The moment

What just happened, in one line?

1 Check the list

What actually happened? (Only what a camera would have recorded.)

What am I making it mean? About me, about them, or about the whole thing?

Is this now, or is this then?

2 Feel what's real

With the meaning set aside, what's left? Name it: disappointment, fear, relief, tiredness, hope.

Where do I feel it in my body?

3 Lift the rope, or don't

Is this rope about how they treat me, or about the surface (looks, shoes, spark, how impressive they are on paper)?

Who do I want to be here? What's one small step that person would take?

Keep the rope up when you see: words and actions that don't match; someone who comes on strong, then goes vague; no questions about you, all night; heavy drinking; being kept on the edge of their life, not in it.

Lifting the rope doesn't mean lowering your standards. It means checking whether the rope is protecting you, or keeping you single.

Nothing is wrong with you. You're just very good at staying safe.